

Chapter 27 — Niphal–Hiphil Contrast Drill

BBH Chapters 25 & 27 · Niphal and Hiphil Weak Verbs

For each form: (1) identify the stem (Niphal or Hiphil); (2) parse — conjugation, PGN; (3) give the root and weak class; (4) translate in context. Answer key is on the last page.

Niphal markers: נִּ prefix (perfect/participle); יִ / יְ / יֹ (imperfect/wayyiqtol — assimilation); יֹנִ (I- perfect/ptc); יֹיְ (I- imperfect); נִ (Biconsonantal perfect/ptc). Hiphil markers: הִ prefix (perfect); יִ (imperfect); הִ (imperative/inf.); מִ (participle) — modified for weak classes: הִ (I-gutt.), הִ / יְ / יֹ (I-), הִ / יְ / יֹ (I-), מִ / יְ / יֹ (Biconsonantal/Geminate).

Part A — Contrasting Niphal and Hiphil (same root)

Niphal = passive/reflexive. Hiphil = causative. Same root, opposite semantic direction.

#	Form	Ref	Context	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Root / Class
1	נִשְׁמַע	Est 1:20	"the decree ____ throughout the				
2	הִשְׁמִיעַ	Isa 48:6	"I ____ you new things"				
3	יִמָּצֵא	Gen 44:10	"he with whom it is ____ shall be my				
4	הִמְצִיא	Neh 9:15	"You ____ them bread from heaven"				
5	נִגְלָה	Isa 40:5	"the glory of the LORD shall ____"				
6	הִעֲלָה	Gen 8:20	"Noah ____ burnt offerings on the				
7	יִגֹּשׁ	Gen 44:18	"Judah ____ him and said"				
8	הִגִּישׁ	Amos 9:13	"the one who ____ grain offering"				

Part B — Weak-Class Focus (I- and Biconsonantal)

I-: Niphal perfect/ptc = יֹנִ; imperfect = יֹיְ (dagesh in י). Hiphil perfect = הִ; imperfect = יִ (no dagesh in י). Biconsonantal: Niphal perfect/ptc = נִ (qamets); Hiphil perfect = הִ (tsere).

#	Form	Ref	Context	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Root / Class
9	נִוֹלַד	Gen 21:3	"a son ____ to Abraham"				
10	יִוֹלַד	Gen 5:3	"Adam ____ a son in his own likeness"				
11	יִזְלַד	Gen 17:17	"shall a child ____ to a man of 100				
12	יִוֹרִיד	1 Sam 2:6	"the LORD ____ to Sheol and raises				
13	הִזְדַּעַ	Est 2:22	"the matter ____ to Mordecai"				
14	הִקִּים	Gen 6:18	"I will ____ my covenant with you"				
15	נִכֹּן	Gen 41:32	"the thing is ____ by God"				

Part C — Mixed Review

#	Form	Ref	Context	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Root / Class
16	יָעַל	Gen 22:2	"and he ____ him as a burnt offering"				
17	יָגַל	Num 24:4	"who sees the vision, ____ eyes"				
18	הָסִב	2 Sam 2:22	"____ from following me"				
19	מַעֲמִידִים	Neh 4:7	"we who were ____ guard over them"				
20	הִרְאָה	1 Kgs 18:1	"Go, ____ yourself to Ahab"				

Reflection Questions

- Items 1–2 (יָעַל and יָגַל) and 3–4 (הָסִב and מַעֲמִידִים): pick one pair and explain in one sentence what the Niphal adds and what the Hiphil adds to the basic Qal meaning.
- Items 9–11 are all from הִרְאָה (I-הִרְאָה). Both stems use a holem-vav cluster. What is the precise difference between Niphal perfect הִרְאָה and Hiphil wayyiqtol הִרְאָה?
- Items 16 and 17 are both apocopated III-הִרְאָה wayyiqtol forms. What vowel under the prefix consonant is decisive in distinguishing Niphal from Hiphil?
- Items 18 (הָסִב, Hiphil Geminat imperative) and 20 (הִרְאָה, Niphal III-הִרְאָה imperative) both have a long prefix vowel rather than the expected strong הִ/הָ. Explain the phonological reason for the long vowel in each case.

Answer Key

#	Form	Stem	Answer
1	נִשְׁמַע	Niphal	Perfect · 3ms · שָׁמַע · III-נ/ע — "was heard" — נָ prefix + patach furtive before ע = Niphal III-נ/ע perfect
2	הִשְׁמיעַ	Hiphil	Perfect · 3ms · שָׁמַע · III-נ/ע — "caused to hear / announced" — הָ + chiriq-yod + patach furtive before ע
3	נִמְצָא	Niphal	Imperfect · 3ms · אָצַח · III-א — "is found" — נָ (dagesh in מ = Niphal assimilation) + tsere + silent א
4	הִמְצִיא	Hiphil	Perfect · 3ms · אָצַח · III-א — "provided / caused to find" — הָ + chiriq-yod + silent final א = Hiphil III-א
5	נִגְלָה	Niphal	Perfect · 3ms · הִלָּח · III-ה — "was revealed" — נָ prefix + final ה = Niphal III-ה perfect
6	הִעֲלָה	Hiphil	Perfect · 3ms · הִלָּע · III-ה + I-gutt. — "offered up" — הָ prefix + hateph-seghol under ע + qamets + ה =
7	נִיָּגַשׁ	Niphal	Wayyiqtol · 3ms · שָׁגַב · I-נ — "drew near (reflexive)" — נָ + dagesh in ג (Niphal I-נ assimilation) without
8	הִגִּישׁ	Hiphil	Perfect · 3ms · שָׁגַב · I-נ — "brought near" — הָ prefix + dagesh in ג (R2); contrast Niphal נִיָּגַשׁ
9	נִוֹלַד	Niphal	Perfect · 3ms · יָלַד · I-ו — "was born" — וָ prefix = Niphal I-ו perfect; patach under R2 (not qamets of
10	יִוֹלַד	Hiphil	Wayyiqtol · 3ms · יָלַד · I-ו — "fathered / begat" — וָ prefix (dagesh in י + holem-vav) = Hiphil I-ו
11	נִיֻּלַּד	Niphal	Imperfect · 3ms · יָלַד · I-ו — "shall be born" — וָ cluster (dagesh in ו) = Niphal I-ו imperfect; contrast
12	יִוִּרֵד	Hiphil	Imperfect · 3ms · יָרַד · I-ו — "brings down" — וָ prefix (holem-vav, no dagesh in ו) = Hiphil I-ו imperfect
13	נִיָּדָע	Niphal	Wayyiqtol · 3ms · יָדַע · I-ו — "became known" — וָ cluster = Niphal I-ו wayyiqtol
14	הִקִּים	Hiphil	Perfect · 3ms · סָקַם · Biconsonantal — "established" — הָ prefix (tsere) = Hiphil Biconsonantal perfect;
15	נִכְוֵן	Niphal	Perfect · 3ms · כָּוַח · Biconsonantal — "is established / firm" — נָ prefix (qamets) = Niphal Biconsonantal
16	נִיעַל	Hiphil	Wayyiqtol · 3ms · הִלָּע · III-ה + I-gutt. — "offered up (apocopated)" — patach prefix (יָ) + composite
17	נִיָּגְלָה	Niphal	Wayyiqtol · 3ms · הִלָּג · III-ה — "were uncovered (apocopated)" — נָ + dagesh in ג (Niphal
18	הִסֵּב	Hiphil	Imperative · 2ms · בִּבֵּס · Geminate — "turn aside!" — הָ prefix (qamets) = Hiphil Biconsonantal/Geminate
19	מַעֲמִידִים	Hiphil	Participle · mp · עָמַד · I-guttural — "stationing / standing guard" — מָ + composite shewa under ע = Hiphil
20	הִרְאָה	Niphal	Imperative · 2ms · הָאָר · III-ה — "show yourself!" — הָ prefix (ר compensatory) + final ה retained =